Teaching Statement

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I teach economics as a way of making decisions. Almost every model students meet, from a firm setting a price to a household deciding how much to save, asks what someone is trying to achieve and then weighs a marginal benefit against a marginal cost. My goal for undergraduates is that they become thoughtful consumers of economics, who reach for this lens when they face a decision at work or in their own lives, or weigh an economic argument in the news. My goal for graduate students is that they become producers of research, who master the mathematical and statistical techniques of the field without losing sight of the economic story those techniques are meant to tell.

Teaching experience

At the University of Florida, I have taught ECP 3703 Managerial Economics, an intermediate-level undergraduate course of about thirty students, as Instructor of Record since Spring 2026, with responsibility for planning the course, presenting the material, and designing assessments. I have also been a teaching assistant in undergraduate, MBA, master's, and Ph.D. courses, including Intermediate Macroeconomics, Economic Data Analysis, International Macroeconomics, Macroeconomic Analysis, and Computational Economics, and in first-year Ph.D. Macroeconomic Theory (ECO 7206), I prepared and led a weekly discussion section. With a response rate of 83.9 percent, students in my first semester as Instructor of Record rated my enthusiasm at 4.54 out of 5 and the clarity of my standards for response and availability at 4.65, above the college mean of 4.46; one wrote that the worksheets were "extremely helpful to practice the concept immediately after we learnt it." I also opted into the university's voluntary midterm evaluation. Students asked me to slow down and work through problems step by step, so I added time in class to show how the textbook material applies to specific economics problems, working through each one step by step.

Undergraduates: building economic intuition through practice

Introductory courses are technically far from research, but the intuition they build is valuable to every student: those who leave economics use it to make decisions, and those who continue make fewer mistakes because they can tell when an answer does not make economic sense. Intuition cannot be memorized; it has to be practiced. I begin a new topic with a concrete decision or a short numerical example and ask students to commit to an answer before we formalize it. When we reach monopoly pricing, students first guess how the price will change, and only then do we derive that marginal revenue equals marginal cost, so that the derivation tests an intuition they have already committed to. They then use the same tool in settings that look different on the surface, such as a coffee shop pricing a latte, an airline charging students and business travelers different fares, and a streaming service weighing a cheaper plan with advertising. My worksheets and practice exams are built on this principle and point out the steps where earlier students most often went wrong. Group homework and practice-exam reviews, in which students explain solutions at the board, make the practice shared, and my feedback separates errors in economic reasoning from errors in calculation.

Graduate students: from consumers to producers of research

Graduate students should bring a solid foundation in mathematics and statistics, and graduate courses already center on technique. Economics uses mathematics without being reducible to it, so while I teach the techniques carefully, I keep returning to why we do things this way. Why solve this problem by backward induction? Why do we care whether an estimate is causal? What are the marginal benefit and marginal cost in this first-order condition? The consumption Euler equation, for example, says that a household is indifferent between consuming one more unit today and saving it for tomorrow; read this way, each optimality condition brings

students back to the intuition they built as undergraduates. In my ECO 7206 section, I wrote out each step of a derivation, explained why it followed, and paused where a common mistake was likely, drawing on the mistakes I had made myself.

My own path is part of why I teach this way. Early in graduate school I concentrated on derivations and problem sets and became a capable consumer of research. After my qualifying exams, I learned to read papers for the question the authors were answering, why they approached it as they did, and what story their evidence tells. I want to help graduate students make that transition earlier than I did, and I would advise research assistants and thesis writers by the same principles: practice with real household data for undergraduates, and for graduate students, technical mastery that keeps returning to the economic question.

Courses I can teach

I am most eager to teach macroeconomics, public economics, and family economics at the undergraduate or graduate level, including graduate macroeconomic theory and computational methods, and I am capable and willing to teach courses outside my primary fields at the undergraduate or master's level. I would like to develop a family economics course and a course I call "Insuring Against Life-Stage Risks," both growing out of my interest in heterogeneous-agent macroeconomics, in which aggregate outcomes are built up from the decisions of households that differ in income, wealth, and family circumstances.